

Teacher Guide & Answer Key

60 SECONDS TO READY

01 ANSWER KEY

QUICK REFERENCE

VOCABULARY

1 – D 2 – E 3 – A 4 – B
5 – C

TRUE OR FALSE

1 T 2 F 3 F 4 T 5 T

LANGUAGE IN CONTEXT

1 come at a cost 2 a race to the bottom
3 salve her conscience 4 On the face of it
5 backfired

TRUE OR FALSE · EVIDENCE

1 “the price on the tag is rarely the whole price” · 2 “shipped abroad in bales” · 3 boycotts “can backfire” · 4 “overall volume of production keeps rising” · 5 “few seem willing to be the first to stop”

CRITICAL THINKING · GOOD INTENTIONS, SIDE EFFECTS

No fixed ratings. Defensible side effects: boycott – garment workers lose jobs; donate – bales swamp markets abroad; eco lines – greenwashing while output rises; tax – hits low-income shoppers hardest; export ban – ends resale jobs abroad and fills landfills at home; buy less – the boycott’s job losses, spread more slowly. Push any pair that rates an action purely positive to name who pays.

02 TEACHER GUIDE

BEFORE CLASS

AIM

Trace the hidden costs of cheap clothing, predict unintended consequences, and defend a plan under challenge.

LENGTH

60–75 minutes.

TIP

Students often rate “buy less” as purely good. Ask who loses when orders fall. Campaigners attack the plan, not the presenters.

EXTENSION

Design a label showing the full cost of a garment. What goes on it?

03 DISCUSSION NOTES

GUIDE THE TALK

STUDENTS MAY MENTION

wages & safety · factory collapses · water & microfibers · secondhand exports · greenwashing · boycotts vs. jobs · regulation

FOLLOW-UP QUESTIONS

- Is cheap clothing a real benefit to low-income shoppers?
- Who should check factory conditions: brands, governments, or buyers?
- Does knowing the true cost actually change what people buy?

ENCOURAGE THIS LANGUAGE

“That rests on the assumption that...” · “I’d concede that..., but...” · “The flaw in that argument is...”

04 MODEL WRITING

SAMPLE ANSWER

On the face of it, shoppers hold real power. Every purchase is a signal, and brands watch sales more closely than any campaign. If enough people refused cheap clothes, the argument goes, fast fashion would have to change or disappear.

Yet individual choices are weaker than they look. Buying an “eco” T-shirt or donating old clothes may **salve our conscience**, but it does little to slow total production. Boycotts can even **backfire**, costing jobs for the very workers they aim to protect. Meanwhile, brands competing in a **race to the bottom** have every reason to keep prices low and conditions hidden.

The deeper problem is that cheapness **comes at a cost** most shoppers never see. Few people can check a supplier’s wages or safety record, and none can do it for every garment they own.

I therefore largely agree. Consumers can buy less and buy better, and that matters at the margins. But lasting change needs rules that make brands answerable for their whole supply chain, because a problem built into a system cannot be solved one shopping basket at a time.